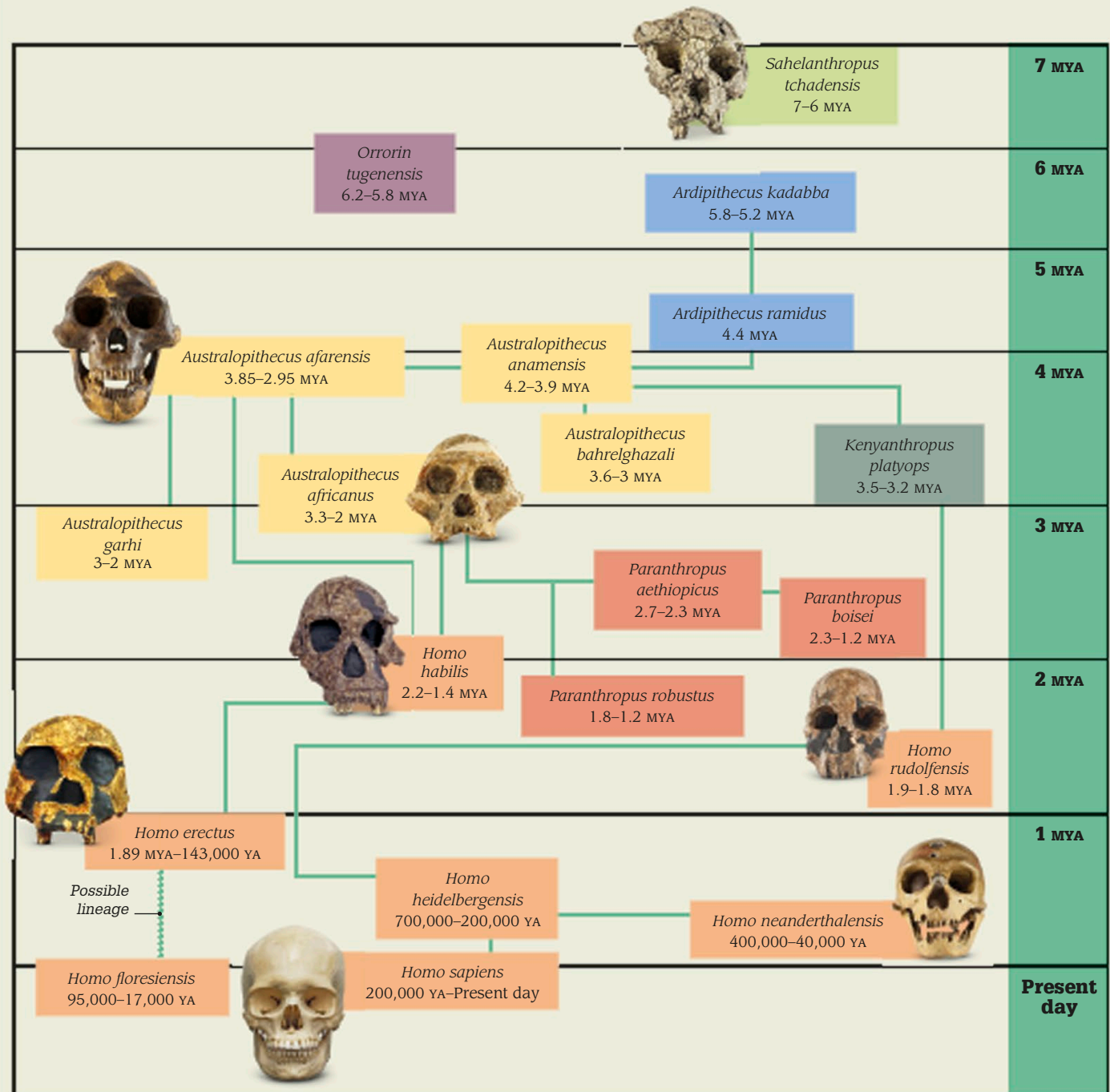


Early humans

Our earliest ancestors—the hominins—lived in Central and Eastern Africa millions of years ago. As fossil evidence is limited, scientists do not know exactly how many human species have existed and how different

species are related to each other. The chart below shows some of the hominin species that have been identified and the dates they flourished.



KEY

- Sahelanthropus probably walked on two legs.
- Ardipithecus was similar in size to a modern chimpanzee.
- Australopithecus had long arms for climbing trees.
- Homo had a larger brain and longer legs than earlier ancestors.
- Orrorin had teeth more like those of humans than apes.
- Kenyanthropus had a flat face, with high cheekbones.
- Paranthropus had teeth for chewing tough plant foods.
- Probable line of descent